Clemens Mill School Council
Meeting Minutes
November 12, 2025

ATTENDEES
(V = voting member)

Robert Wilson - Principal
Andi Gourlay - Vice-Principal
Kim Fowler - community rep
Bibi Corbeil - teacher rep
Cherain Serrador - Chair
Ashley Church (V)
Chantelle Tinnes (V)
Zac Jones (V)
Rhonda Chamberlain (V)
Shannon Wall (V)
Christine Dalsto (V)
Amy Ellison (V)
Vina Danger (V)
Yvonne Branski (V)
Cindy Ma (V)
Stephanie MacLachlan (V)
Selena Mather (V)
Dipesh Patel (V)
Rene Corbeil (V)
Rebecca Goodard

Regrets
Vasco Serrador (V)

Meeting Minutes

1. Welcome
    - New attendees Selena and Rebecca

2. Principals Update
    - Wants to start sharing more on what the staff is working on
    - Fantastic Remembrance Day assembly
    - PD Day 17 Nov
    - Progress Reports 18 Nov. Lots of positive comments and hoping for no surprises for guardians/caregivers
    - New project adding “Core Board” communication tool to outdoor area near kindies
    - WRDSB focusing on literacy and math in small group instruction. Also focusing on a sense of belonging, positive and encouraging language.

3. Budget Update
    - Nov started at $107k, ending at $49.3k
    - 62K spent on playground, amount was overestimated
    - Bingo and Pizza doing well
    - Restrictions on Bingo money - must be for all to use/universal use and for enhancements to the school, not for core items
    - Currently our Bingo reporting is in line with their requirements

4. School Sign Update
    - 3 approved vendors, 1 vendor has come out to inspect and start an initial quote
    - Debating having 2 or 3 sections to the sign
    - Sign will include Clemens Mill name and logo, WRDSB logo and YMCA logo, and address
    - Planning to have sign backlit so its visible from the road (possibly on a timer)
    - With electrical work being added the quote will probably be under $10k
    - Hoping to reuse current parts of the sign to keep costs low
    - No estimated date yet but progress is being made

5. 2025/26 Budget Discussion & Approval
    - Listed the requirements/restrictions on school council budget
    - $49.7k carryover from last year
    - With proposed yearly revenue a total of $64.9k expected for the 25/26 year
    - Rob and Cheraine worked through the draftnbudget together proposing expenditure of $35.5k, leaving $29.4k unassigned
    - Grade 8 End of Year trip - proposed funding increased $2.5k since last year. Aiming to increase the number who can attend the overnight camp and also provide day activities at the school for those who cannot attend
    - Possible option to open the trip up to Grade 7 and 8 and only have it every 2nd year
    - Advised that if more money is needed for the trip, school council can be approached for additional funding
    - Students who want to attend but can't due to monetary constraints can be paid for out of the student support school funds
    - Motion by Zac to vote on the proposed budget:
        - 15 YES - budget APPROVED

6. Investment & Spending Discussion
    - Musical instruments - school council can supplement the request if any grants are awarded. If no grants are awarded the school council can fully fund
    - Front school landscaping - refresh and use indigenous plants. Suggestions to get students/ families involved e.g. building bird houses
    - Beach volleyball - replace the posts and nets

- PRO Grant - proposing an inclusive Games Night. Event will be free and families will be given a game to take home with instructions available in multiple languages
- Mandate from Rob that events be inclusive as much as possible and without any financial barrier. Free food and activities so that families can attend without worrying about the cost
- No school play this year
- Traverse wall - old suggestion. Fiddlesticks would contribute towards this as they would also benefit from it
- Cambridge Community Players Theatre advertising tickets to their school performance of “Puff” on Dec 02. Rob to discuss with teachers.

7. Subcommittee Update
    - Tabled for next meeting

8. Bingo Update
    - Tabled for next meeting

9. WRAPSC Update
    - Subcommittee focusing on opposing Bill 33
    - Special presentation by Dr Alison Yeung on the connection between mental health, smart phones and social media. More info available at @thesmartphoneeffectMD
    - PRO Grant deadline 28 Nov

10. Meeting close
    - Next meeting Wednesday December 10 @ 7pm
    - Cheraine proposed the meeting to be held in-person at the school library with food/drink provided. A vote was held but did not receive sufficient votes for a clear majority. Cheraine will send out email to voting council members for a revote
    - Next meeting will focus on how to spend the remaining funds